STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-7600

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **09/20/18**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL	RESOURCES
SUBJECT EMPLOYEE ASSISTANCE PROGRAM	CROSS REFERENCE G-5500 LEAVE REQUESTS

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to provide guidelines for the Employee Assistance Program.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office shall make available an Employee Assistance Program (EAP) to assist sworn and non-sworn employees in identifying and resolving problems or concerns that may adversely affect an employee's personal and professional life.

III. Procedures:

A. Description of EAP Services:

1. EAP services are available to sworn and non-sworn employees and their families experiencing personal problems, financial and legal worries, or problems caused by drug and alcohol abuse.

2. EAP services include initial assessment and motivational counseling in an appropriate and timely manner. If further assistance is necessary, EAP will recommend a suitable referral source. Participants may be referred to workplace or community resources for diagnosis, treatment, and follow-up.

3. All information given to EAP shall remain confidential within statutory guidelines. All EAP records shall be kept confidential and shall not be included in an employee's personnel file. A client's information may be obtained from EAP only with the written permission of the client.

4. Sarpy County shall not be obligated to pay fees for referral resources beyond EAP except to the extent that the employee's health plan provides insurance coverage.

5. Employees have the option to refuse voluntary referral to the EAP and may discontinue their participation in voluntary EAP at any time.

B. Procedures for Obtaining Services:

1. Voluntary Referral:

a) Sworn and non-sworn employees who are experiencing personal or family problems may schedule an appointment with EAP.

b) Employees who feel a need for individual and confidential critical incident stress management may also contact EAP.

c) EAP shall be provided by Alegent EAP. Employees may contact Alegent EAP by calling (402) 398-5566 or 1-888-847-4975. Further information may be obtained at Alegenteap.com or from the Sarpy County Personnel Department.

2. Supervisor Referral: Supervisory personnel throughout the county shall be responsible for promoting the availability of EAP resources to employees.

a) When unsatisfactory job performance leads to disciplinary action, a supervisor may advise an employee of the availability of EAP.

b) Only the initial assessment/counseling time with EAP shall be considered "on-duty" time for supervisor referrals. Leave time for follow-up sessions with EAP and/or referral agencies shall be handled in accordance with standard leave policies (G-5500 Leave Requests).

3. Mandatory Referral: The Sheriff or Chief Deputy may require a sworn or non-sworn employee to participate in EAP treatment when there are issues that may be effecting the employees job performance or personal well-being.

a) A mandatory referral to EAP may occur simultaneously with disciplinary action for unsatisfactory job performance.

b) The employee may be required to sign a release form allowing EAP to report back to the Sheriff's Office the following information:

(1) The dates of appointments with EAP.

(2) The verifications that the employee is following through with the recommended course of action.

c) Assessment/counseling time with EAP shall be considered “on-duty” time for mandatory referrals. This shall include all follow-up appointments recommended by EAP.

d) Employees shall follow through with the mandatory referral to contact EAP and to cooperate with the recommended course of action. Employees who refuse assistance or who do not respond to or fail to successfully complete the recommended course of action shall be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination for the original unsatisfactory job performance.